# Frontend Engineer Take-Home: Campaign Builder

Oct 23, 2026 · @Zoca - Scheduling Pod

Design and build a working campaign builder that takes a salon or spa owner from an idea to a launched text and email campaign in a few minutes. Submit by end of day Oct 26, 2026.

## Context

Zoca helps salons, spas and other beauty and wellness businesses grow. Text and email campaigns are among the best ways they have to bring clients back: a slow-Tuesday promo, a holiday gift card push, a nudge to clients who haven't visited in 90 days.

The people running these campaigns are owners and front-desk managers, not marketers. They often work from a phone or the front-desk tablet between appointments, with a few minutes to spare. They know their clients well but don't think in "segments" or "open rates". A good tool does the heavy lifting for them. It turns a rough idea into a campaign they're proud to send, and it never makes them feel lost.

This frontend engineer role has a strong design focus. We care as much about the decisions you make for the user as about the code you write. Treat this as a product you're shipping, not a set of features to tick off.

## The flow

A campaign is ready to launch once it has four inputs: **channel**, **content**, **audience** and **send time**. The builder should help the owner set each one, starting from a suggestion or a prompt and ending with a launch. How you present the steps is up to you: a wizard, a single canvas, a chat-led flow or something else. Owners should be able to go back and change any input before they launch.

1. **Start.** Pick a suggested campaign or describe one in a prompt, and AI drafts all four inputs.
2. **Channel.** Choose text, email or both.
3. **Content.** Review and edit the message for each chosen channel, by hand or with AI.

4. **Audience.** See who will get the campaign. Pick an existing segment or build a custom one.
5. **Send time.** Send now or schedule for later.
6. **Launch.** Review all four inputs in one place, then launch. Show what happens next.

## Requirements

These are the must-haves. Anything beyond them is your call, and we'd rather see fewer things done beautifully than everything done roughly.

### 1. Start

- Show a set of suggested campaigns relevant to a salon or spa, such as "Win back clients who haven't visited in 3 months", "Fill empty slots this week", "Holiday gift cards" and "Birthday treat".
- Let the owner write a free-form prompt instead, like "20% off balayage for regulars before Diwali".
- Either path produces a complete first draft: a campaign name, a suggested channel, the message for each channel (for email, a subject line and body), a suggested audience and a suggested send time.
- Handle the wait while AI is working, and handle a vague or unhelpful prompt gracefully.

### 2. Channel

- Let the owner choose text, email or both.
- Pre-select the channel the AI suggested, and let the owner change it easily.
- Show how the choice affects reach, for example "212 clients can get a text, 168 can get an email".
- Keep the content step in sync with the choice. Choosing both shows both messages. Switching from both to one shouldn't silently throw away edits.

### 3. Content

- Show each message for the chosen channels as the client would see it, not only as form fields.
- Let the owner edit each one directly.

- Let the owner revise with AI. This can be quick actions (shorter, friendlier, more urgent, add an offer) and/or a free-form instruction. Make it easy to compare with the previous version or undo.
- Respect the limits of each channel. For example, show the character count and segment count for SMS, and keep an opt-out line ("Reply STOP to unsubscribe").
- Support personalization such as the client's first name, and show what it looks like with real data.

## 4. Audience

- Show the suggested audience and how many clients are in it.
- Let the owner browse existing segments, such as "All clients", "New clients (last 30 days)", "Lapsed 90+ days" and "VIP".
- Let the owner build a custom segment by combining filters, for example last visit date, number of visits, services booked, upcoming appointments, total spend and birthday month.
- Update the audience size live as filters change, and let the owner preview who's in it.
- Account for reachability: some clients have no email, no phone or have opted out of a channel. Make it clear how many people each channel will actually reach.
- Let the owner save a custom segment for reuse.

## 5. Send time

- Offer "Send now" and "Schedule for later" with a date and time picker.
- Use the salon's time zone, and prevent scheduling in the past.
- A sensible suggestion is welcome, such as a better send time, but not required.

## 6. Launch

- Show a final review of all four inputs: channel, content, audience (with reach per channel) and send time.
- Don't allow launch until all four inputs are set, and point the owner to whatever is missing.
- Confirm before sending, since a sent campaign can't be taken back.
- After launch, show a clear success state and what happens next. A scheduled campaign should be editable or cancellable until it goes out.

### Across the whole flow

- Works well on a phone and on a desktop.
- Thoughtful empty, loading and error states.
- Accessible: keyboard navigation, visible focus, enough contrast and labelled controls.

## Ground rules

- **Stack:** your choice. We use React and TypeScript, so that's a plus, but use whatever lets you do your best work.
- **AI:** call a real model (any provider) or mock the responses convincingly. If you use a real API, don't commit your key; a short note on how to run it is enough. We're judging the experience around AI, not the model's output.
- **Backend:** none needed. Mock data, local state or local storage is fine. Nothing needs to actually send.
- **Design:** no design files are provided. Bring your own visual direction, and design it in code or in a tool first, whichever you prefer.
- **AI coding tools:** welcome. Tell us briefly how you used them.
- **Time:** If you run short, cut scope and tell us what you'd do next rather than rushing everything.
- **Out of scope:** login, billing, real sending, analytics after launch and multi-location support.

## Mock data

Build against a fictional salon, "Lumen Hair & Spa", with 150–300 generated clients. Extend the shape below however you need. Generate the rest with a script or by hand.

```
id,first_name,last_name,phone,email,sms_opt_in,email_opt_in,first_visit,last_
visit,total_visits,total_spend_usd,services,next_appointment,birthday
c001,Priya,Shah,+15125550101,priya@example.com,true,true,2023-02-14,2026-10-
02,18,2140,"Balayage;Haircut;Gloss",2026-11-06,1991-03-22
c002,Maria,Lopez,+15125550102,,true,false,2025-06-01,2026-05-
19,4,380,"Haircut;Blowout",,1988-11-04
c003,Jordan,Lee,,jordan@example.com,false,true,2026-09-20,2026-09-
20,1,95,Facial,,1997-07-30
c004,Aisha,Khan,+15125550104,aisha@example.com,true,true,2022-08-11,2026-10-
18,31,4620,"Keratin;Haircut;Manicure",2026-10-30,1985-12-09
c005,Emily,Chen,+15125550105,emily@example.com,false,false,2024-01-05,2025-
12-12,6,510,"Massage;Facial",,1993-10-28
```

Filter fields the custom segment builder should support:

| Field | Example filter |
|---|---|
| Last visit | More than 90 days ago |
| Total visits | 5 or more |
| Services booked | Includes Balayage or Color |
| Next appointment | None booked |
| Total spend | Over $1,000 |
| First visit | Within the last 30 days |
| Birthday | In November |
| Channel | Reachable by SMS |

## What to submit

Send these by end of day Oct 26, 2026 :

1. **A live link** to the deployed app (Vercel, Netlify or similar) that works without setup.
2. **The source code** in a GitHub repo, public or shared with us.
3. **A short write-up** in the README, under one page: the key design decisions and why, the trade-offs, what you cut, and what you'd do with another week.

4. **A walkthrough video** of 3–5 minutes (Loom or similar) taking us through the flow and your thinking.

In the follow-up interview, you'll walk us through your work and we'll talk about the decisions behind it.

## How we evaluate

We weigh user-first thinking and design quality most heavily, then how well it's built.

| Area | What great looks like |
|---|---|
| User-first problem solving | A busy owner can launch a good campaign in minutes without help. The flow anticipates their mistakes and questions. |
| Visual and interaction design | Clear hierarchy, considered type and spacing, a coherent visual language, and motion that helps rather than decorates. |
| AI experience | AI feels helpful and in the owner's control. Waiting, revising, comparing and undoing all feel natural. |
| Craft and detail | Edge cases, empty and error states, mobile layout and accessibility are handled with care. |
| Code quality | Readable, well-structured components and sensible state management that another engineer could pick up. |
| Communication | The write-up and video explain the why behind decisions and are honest about trade-offs. |

Questions are welcome at any time. Reply to the email this came with, and we'll get back to you quickly, including over the weekend.